

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Rails, service and safeguard

RAILS -> identity, payments, documents, consent, commerce and health infrastructure

SERVICE -> a specific departmental portal delivered on those rails

SAFEGUARD -> the data-protection statute, rules and enforcing body

WHY IT MATTERS -> rails raise systemic risks; a service raises departmental ones

MUST REMEMBER: Digital public infrastructure supplies reusable population-scale rails for...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: The stack card

IDENTITY -> Aadhaar under the Aadhaar Act, 2016; UIDAI; not proof of citizenship

PAYMENTS -> Unified Payments Interface operated by the National Payments Corporation of India

DOCUMENTS -> DigiLocker under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

CONSENT -> Account Aggregator regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under DEPA

COMMERCE AND HEALTH -> Open Network for Digital Commerce; Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Two consent constructs

ACCOUNT AGGREGATOR -> finance-specific; Reserve Bank regulated; cannot view or store the data

CONSENT MANAGER -> general-purpose registration under the 2025 Rules; commences 13 November 2026

SHARED LOGIC -> give, manage, review and withdraw consent through an interoperable platform

ERROR PREVENTED -> treating one registration as the other in a close-option question

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Layer-specific risk matrix

IDENTITY -> who is excluded by authentication failure

PAYMENTS AND DOCUMENTS -> who lacks the device, connectivity or literacy to self-serve

COMMERCE -> does the open protocol give smaller sellers genuinely equal visibility

HEALTH -> is sensitive data with higher re-identification risk adequately safeguarded

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Three-tranche commencement

13 NOVEMBER 2025 -> definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, section 44(1) and 44(3)

13 NOVEMBER 2026 -> section 6(9) consent managers and section 27(1)(d)

13 MAY 2027 -> sections 3 to 5, sections 7 to 17 rights, sections 27 to 34 and section 44(2)

NOTIFICATIONS -> G.S.R. 843(E) commencement; G.S.R. 846(E) Rules; G.S.R. 892(E) corrigendum

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: The section 44 split

SECTION 44(3) -> substitutes the personal-information exemption in the transparency statute

STATUS -> immediate tranche; operative since 13 and 14 November 2025

SECTION 44(2) -> amends the Information Technology Act, 2000

STATUS -> deferred to 13 May 2027; challenges filed and no final judgment located

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Enforcement sequence

STAGE 1 ESTABLISHED -> the Board exists in law under section 18

STAGE 2 RECRUITMENT -> applications invited in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members

STAGE 3 PROCEDURE -> rules of procedure and digital-first conduct of proceedings

STAGE 4 AND 5 -> commenced substantive duties, then decided cases

CAUTION -> no appointment order located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Authentication dependency

POPULATION-SCALE IDENTITY -> efficient targeting and de-duplication

AUTHENTICATION DEPENDENCY -> access becomes conditional on successful verification

FAILURE MODES -> worn biometrics, connectivity drop, address mismatch

OUTCOME -> inclusion at the median with a denial tail among intended beneficiaries

MITIGATION -> offline override, which reintroduces some discretion; a trade-off, not a fix

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Interoperability against purpose limitation

INTEROPERABILITY -> the same rails reused across many public and private services

PURPOSE LIMITATION -> data collected for one purpose may not be silently reused

RECONCILERS -> granular purpose-specific consent, purpose tagging, data minimisation

PRACTICAL FAILURE -> consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Six binding constraints

DEVICE -> household handset shared and controlled by one member

CONNECTIVITY -> quality and cost, not merely coverage

LANGUAGE -> content and error messages outside the user's script

FUNCTIONAL LITERACY -> completing a task, not operating a phone

TRUST AND AUTHENTICATION -> fear of error, worn fingerprints, address mismatch

CLOSE DISTINCTION: DPI is not every government portal, a digital identity is not...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Intermediary paradox and four safeguards

REALISTIC ROUTE -> assisted access through a centre, a shopkeeper or a family member

NEW RISK -> a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's own credentials

SAFEGUARDS 1 AND 2 -> necessity and proportionality; minimisation with purpose tagging

SAFEGUARDS 3 AND 4 -> assisted and offline fallback; reasoned human review and appeal

EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use Aadhaar, UPI, DigiLocker, Account...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Answer spine for an adequacy demand

OPEN -> separate rails, service and safeguard, and name the layer at issue

BUILD -> state the tranche, the section and the date before evaluating adequacy

TEST -> exclusion tail, consent quality, reuse tension, enforcement stage

CLOSE -> graded verdict with a pending-challenge caveat and correct grievance routing